CASE STUDY



SANDEEP SAHDEV

"THE KEY IS BALANCE AND PATIENCE"

ROHIT SHARMA, 44

Tech entrepreneur | Panchkula, Haryana

Rohit's journey as an investor began like that of many Indians: in a middle-class home, in a Tier-2 town, where gold, fixed deposits and real estate were the only trusted ways to save. The son of government employees, he grew up wary of the stock market—viewing it more as a gamble than a path to prosperity.

In the early 2000s, newly married and eager to grow his savings, Rohit dipped a toe into day trading. With just Rs 20,000, he tried his luck. It didn't last long—12 sessions in, the money was gone. Spooked, he returned to safer ground.

Two decades later, during the Covid-19 lockdown, a quieter shift began. With more time, better access to information and a need to make his money work harder, he decided to try again. This time, he approached it like a student, reading company reports and tracking sectoral trends. Today, nearly 90 per cent of his savings are spread across mutual funds, equities and bonds. Since 2020, he has averaged a 14 per cent annual return. "The key is balance and patience," he says. **—ASM**

"IN SOME WAY, I FEEL ALIGNED WITH INDIA'S ECONOMIC ASPIRATIONS"



"I DON'T HAVE A PROBLEM WITH GAMIFICATION—MAKING THINGS EASIER TO ACCESS AND USE SHOULD BE THE WAY FORWARD. THE REAL CHALLENGE IS SELF-CONTROL"

SAURABH MUKHERJEA, *Founder & Chief Investment Officer, Marcellus Investment Managers*

on F&O trades, and tightened capital gains rules. The RBI's crackdown on unsecured lending began to show results: by February 2025, the growth rate in credit card dues had cooled to 11.2 per cent year-on-year. Then, in April, SEBI directed stock exchanges to monitor intra-day position limits in real-time, using random snapshots to detect breaches early. The result was swift: retail activity in high-risk index options dropped by nearly 70 per cent from late 2024 levels. In another significant reform, SEBI has mandated that all algorithmic trading strategies be registered and audited to ensure a level playing field against institutional players like the US-based Jane Street, which is in hot water for allegedly exploiting ultra-fast algorithms to manipulate expiry-day trades on Nifty, giving it an unfair edge over regular investors.

THE FUTURE IS NOW

As the dust settles, a new pattern is emerging: ordinary investors are not running scared, they are evolving. "Data from the markets makes us confident that the surge of middle-class investment hasn't stopped, just moved to more mature products," says Kela. Crucially, the fundamentals of the Indian economy must stay strong. The GDP is expected to grow around 6.3–6.8 per cent in FY26, on the back of robust consumer demand, public infrastructure spending and urbanisation trends. What happens next will define India's financial future. For the retail revolution to endure, regulation must keep pace with innovation; financial education must scale alongside enthusiasm. And policymakers must see the middle class not just as a tax base, but as a cornerstone of long-term growth. ■